Unai Fischer Abaigar

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Faculty Fellow / Data Science Assistant Professor, New York University

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Google Scholar

Academic Appointments

New York University — New York, NY
Faculty Fellow / Data Science Assistant Professor, Center for Data Science — Sep 2026–present

Massachusetts Institute of Technology — Cambridge, MA
Visiting Student, Laboratory for Information and Decision Systems — Apr–May 2026
Hosted by Sendhil Mullainathan and Juan Carlos Perdomo.

Institute for Employment Research (IAB) — Nuremberg, Germany
Guest Researcher — Sep 2025–present

Harvard University — Cambridge, MA
Fellow, Harvard SEAS and CRCS — Sep–Dec 2024
Hosted by Cynthia Dwork and Juan Carlos Perdomo.

Hertie School Data Science Lab — Berlin, Germany
Research Associate — May–Jul 2022
Hosted by Slava Jankin and Lynn Kaack.

Central Institute for Mental Health — Mannheim, Germany
Research Assistant, Reallabor AI4U — Mar–Aug 2022

Education

LMU Munich — Munich, Germany
Ph.D. (Dr. rer. nat.) in Statistics, magna cum laude (0,76) — Oct 2022 - July 2026
Dissertation: *Foundations of Prediction in the Public Sphere*.
Advised by Frauke Kreuter and Christoph Kern, with Avi Feller and Julia Stoyanovich serving as examiners.
Affiliated with the Munich Center for Machine Learning (MCML).

Ruprecht Karl University of Heidelberg — Heidelberg, Germany
M.Sc. in Physics — Apr 2020 - Mar 2022
Thesis: *Modeling Ordinal Mobile Data with Sequential Variational Autoencoders*.
Advised by Daniel Durstewitz.

Ruprecht Karl University of Heidelberg — Heidelberg, Germany
B.Sc. in Physics — Oct 2016 - Feb 2020
Thesis: *Modeling the Evolution of Cooperation through Indirect Reciprocity*.
Advised by Kurt Roth.

Honors and Awards

LMU-NYU Research Cooperation Program — 2025
- EUR 10,000 in project funding for *Foundations of Statistical Prediction in the Public Sphere*.

ICML Outstanding Paper Award — 2025
- One of six papers selected out of 12,000 submissions; awarded for *The Value of Prediction in Identifying the Worst-Off*.

Konrad Zuse School for Excellence in Reliable AI — 2023–2026
- Doctoral fellowship and advanced training program.

German Academic Scholarship Foundation (*Studienstiftung des deutschen Volkes*) — 2016–2020
- Scholarship awarded to fewer than 0.5% of German students.

Publications

- **Unai Fischer-Abaigar**, Emily Aiken, Christoph Kern, and Juan Carlos Perdomo. "On the Meta-Design of Allocation Problems." *Advances in Neural Information Processing Systems (NeurIPS)*, 2026.
- Julian Rodemann, **Unai Fischer-Abaigar**, James Bailie, and Krikamol Muandet. "Performative Learning Theory." *International Conference on Machine Learning (ICML)*, 2026.

- **Unai Fischer-Abaigar**, Christoph Kern, and Juan Carlos Perdomo. "The Value of Prediction in Identifying the Worst-Off." *International Conference on Machine Learning (ICML)*, 2025. **Outstanding Paper Award**; highlight track at FORC 2025.
- Christoph Kern, **Unai Fischer-Abaigar**, Jonas Schweisthal, Dennis Frauen, Rayid Ghani, Stefan Feuerriegel, Mihaela van der Schaar, and Frauke Kreuter. "Algorithms for Reliable Decision-Making Need Causal Reasoning." *Nature Computational Science*, 2025.
- **Unai Fischer-Abaigar**, Christoph Kern, Noam Barda, and Frauke Kreuter. "Bridging the Gap: Towards an Expanded Toolkit for AI-Driven Decision-Making in the Public Sector." *Government Information Quarterly* 41(4), 2024.
- **Unai Fischer-Abaigar**, Christoph Kern, and Frauke Kreuter. "The Missing Link: Allocation Performance in Causal Machine Learning." *ICML Workshop on Humans, Algorithmic Decision-Making and Society*, 2024.
- Christian Götzl, Selina Hiller, Christian Rauschenberg, Anita Schick, Janik Fechtelpeter, **Unai Fischer-Abaigar**, Georgia Koppe, Daniel Durstewitz, Ulrich Reininghaus, and Silvia Krumm. "Artificial Intelligence-Informed Mobile Mental Health Apps for Young People: A Mixed-Methods Approach on Users' and Stakeholders' Perspectives." *Child and Adolescent Psychiatry and Mental Health* 16, 2022.

Talks

- *The Value of Prediction in Allocation* — Oct 2026
  CDS Seminar, New York University
- *Understanding the Value of Prediction in Allocation* — Mar 2026
  EAAMO Bridges Inequality Working Group, virtual
- *The Value of Prediction in Identifying the Worst-Off* — Jul 2025
  ICML, oral presentation, Vancouver
- *Adjusting Survey Estimates Using Multiaccuracy Postprocessing* — Jul 2025
  ITACOSM, Bologna
- *The Value of Prediction in Identifying the Worst-Off* — Jun 2025
  FORC, Stanford University
- *The Value of Prediction in Identifying the Worst-Off* — May 2025
  Social Foundations of Computation, Max Planck Institute for Intelligent Systems, Tübingen
- *Algorithmic Decision-Making in the Public Sector* — Oct 2024
  Theory of Computation Graduate Student Seminar, Harvard University
- *Introduction to Automated Decision-Making* — Oct 2024
  Coleridge Initiative, University of Maryland
- *Machine Learning for Reliable Decision-Making* — Apr 2024
  Zuse Industry Workshop on Algorithmic Decision-Making
- *Challenges for ML-Supported Decision-Making* — Jan 2024
  Department of Statistics Seminar, LMU Munich

Teaching

New York University
Responsible Data Science (DS-UA 202)
Instructor — Spring 2027

LMU Munich
Advanced Methods in Social Statistics and Social Data Science
Co-instructor — Summer 2024, 2025
Machine Learning Meets Causality
Co-instructor — Winter 2023
Computational Social Science
Teaching assistant — Winter 2022, 2023, 2025

Ruprecht Karl University of Heidelberg
Machine Learning for Real-World Challenges
Teaching assistant — Summer 2022
Dynamical Systems Theory in Machine Learning and Data Science
Teaching assistant — Winter 2021

Professional Service and Outreach

NeurIPS Top Reviewer 2026
Conference reviewer: ICML; NeurIPS
Member, EAAMO Bridges Inequality Working Group 2026
Co-organizer, Data Science for Social Good Munich 2023, 2024
Organizing team, DataFest Germany 2023, 2025
Media Coverage, NYU Center for Data Science, Executive Code Podcast, Interview at AIHub

Personal

Native speaker of Spanish and German, fluent in English. Long-standing commitment to science outreach. From high school through my undergraduate studies I was active in *Netzwerk Teilchenwelt*, a German initiative that makes particle physics accessible to students, where I took part in project work at CERN, made a prize-winning short film explaining the Standard Model, and later coordinated fellow activities at the Heidelberg site.